

AMD brings FreeSync and Radeon Pro driver to Linux

AMD has added intrinsic support for FreeSync and brought the Radeon Pro driver to Linux. The new updates are supposed to improve the gaming and virtual reality (VR) experience on the open source platform.



Notably, this is the first time FreeSync has been made available on Linux. It improves the rendering experience of videos and games by reducing image lag and stutter, and helps in direct communication with the display.

In addition to the latest support, AMD can create high-quality VR content with its new Radeon Pro Software Linux driver. The driver is optimised to make the best of Radeon Pro GPUs on Polaris architecture. This will help professionals working on CAD/CAM and engineering applications to use Linux more efficiently.

AMD is trying to establish itself in this important niche market of high-performance GPUs. Most of these high-performance use cases have so far been supported on Windows. However, the latest updates from AMD will help in developing the Linux environment as a multimedia platform. The open source community has also changed its approach towards Linux. Multiple options like SteamOS and Vulkan API are designed to improve the gaming experience on Linux platforms.

The new updates by AMD are supported on Red Hat Enterprise Linux, CentOS and Ubuntu. Additionally, the Radeon Pro Software Linux driver works on platforms like the Vulkan API as well.

Red Hat's OpenShift now on Google Cloud

Red Hat has expanded OpenShift by announcing its dedicated presence on Google Cloud Platform. The open source Platform-as-a-Service (PaaS) was previously offering cloud support on Amazon Web Services.

With OpenShift Dedicated on Google Cloud Platform, enterprise customers can build, launch and manage their applications right on Google's cloud solution. The new offering also enables users to speed adoption of Docker containers and Kubernetes, and brings advanced cloud-native application patterns.

"By expanding OpenShift Dedicated to now include Google Cloud Platform, our customers' apps that run

Bluetooth 5 is here, promising to drive IoT adoption

The Bluetooth Special Interest Group (SIG) has just announced the fifth version of its wireless protocol. Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) technology is likely to gain considerably from the new upgrade.

Bluetooth 5 is touted to be twice as fast for low-power applications than the preceding version. The speed of the latest Bluetooth standard could be as fast as 2Mbps. The new technology supposedly covers four times broader range, which could be an entire house or at least a floor of a building.

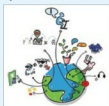
Mark Powell, executive director of the Bluetooth SIG, believes that Bluetooth 5 opens up new possibilities for IoT devices.

"With the launch of Bluetooth 5, we continue

to evolve to meet the needs of IoT developers and consumers while staying true to what Bluetooth is at its core—the global wireless standard for simple and secure connectivity," he said.

The concepts of smart homes and connected home automation products are still in the nascent stage. But home automation with Bluetooth 5 is predicted to become a lot easier. It would also enhance smartphones of the present age. However, it will take two to three years for all mobile devices to feature Bluetooth 5.

BLE devices have already outnumbered Bluetooth enabled products. The fifth-generation technology is expected to boost this growth further and drive the adoption of BLE devices even higher. The new speed and range for BLE will help enterprises use BLE-powered beacons for location. A high rise in the adoption of BLE products is expected to continue to help users broadcast data.



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